

SS Credit: Open Space

This credit applies to

- ▶ BD+C: New Construction (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Core and Shell (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Schools (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Retail (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Data Centers (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Warehouses and Distribution Centers (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Hospitality (1 point)
- ▶ BD+C: Healthcare (1 point)

INTENT

To create exterior open space that encourages interaction with the environment, social interaction, passive recreation, and physical activities.

REQUIREMENTS

NC, CS, SCHOOLS, RETAIL, DATA CENTERS, WAREHOUSES & DISTRIBUTION CENTERS, HOSPITALITY, HEALTHCARE

Provide outdoor space greater than or equal to 30% of the total site area (including building footprint).

At least 25% of the required outdoor open space must be vegetated space planted with two or more types of vegetation or have *overhead vegetated canopy*.

The outdoor space must be physically accessible and be one or more of the following:

- ▶ social area: a pedestrian-oriented paving or landscape area that accommodate outdoor social activities;
- ▶ recreational area: a recreation-oriented paving or landscape area that encourage physical activity;
- ▶ diverse green space: a landscape area with two or more types of vegetation that provide opportunities for year-round visual interest;
- ▶ garden: a garden space dedicated to community gardens or urban food production; or
- ▶ habitat area: preserved or created habitat that meets the criteria of SS Credit Protect or Restore Habitat and includes elements of human interaction. These areas automatically meet the vegetation criteria of this credit.

Extensive or intensive vegetated roofs that are physically accessible can be used toward the minimum vegetation requirement, and qualifying roof-based physically accessible paving areas can be used toward credit compliance.

Wetlands or naturally designed ponds may count as open space if the side slope gradients average 1:4 (vertical:horizontal) or less and are vegetated.

GUIDANCE

Refer to the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following additions:

Behind the Intent

Beta Update

Updates clarify requirements about the percentage of outdoor space and vegetated space to qualify as open space. Projects must provide outdoor space greater than or equal to 30% of the total site area. Of the total outdoor open space required, a minimum of 25% must be vegetated or have overhead vegetated canopy. Minimal changes to verbiage regarding vegetation have also been made to clarify types of vegetation that meet the requirements.

Further Explanation**Connection to Ongoing Performance:**

- ▶ LEED O+M SS credit Rainwater Management: Vegetated landscape areas with native or adapted vegetation will help provide applicable strategies to earn the related credit.
- ▶ LEED O+M SS credit Heat Island Reduction: Vegetated roofs can be counted for both credits.